

(Colossians 3:23). I tried to share with my children that they need to be the best that they can be. That doesn't mean that they can be the best in the world; they may not have that ability. It means that they should be the best they are capable of being. If Christian employees would only manifest two biblical characteristics, there would never be an unemployed Christian. First, give honor to the authority over them, doing everything possible to promote that authority. Second, do the best job possible within their abilities.

(3) *Pay fairly, within your budget, but don't overpay because you can afford it.* I have a good friend who has lived to regret this practice. When his children went to work for him, he started them out at about \$8 an hour. By the time they graduated from high school, they were making nearly \$20 an hour! When they went to college, he bought each of them a brand-new automobile. Then when they graduated from college he decided they were on their own and no longer his "responsibility." Unfortunately, he had preconditioned their expectations. They had made \$20 an hour mowing lawns and drove new cars in college. What employer would be able to match that? None, he found out. His children still shift from job to job, looking for that executive position that will match their expectations.

You need to be very careful that you don't overpay. Remember, the principles that you're trying to build into your children's lives have to sustain them throughout their lifetimes. So pay fairly, but don't overpay.

(4) *Use visual reinforcement, especially for young children.* Most parents find that a chart on the back of a door works very well. Not every child is motivated by charts, but most are. My number-two son could have cared less about charts. He would say, "Forget the stars. How much does it pay?" Not literally, but almost that bad.

Most young children are motivated by praise and rewards, and charts serve that function well. One thing children will demand is honesty. If you say a star represents a job well done, be sure you're faithful to that rule. Almost always one child, especially a girl, will be the guardian of the rules. Chil-